

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠J

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦K

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣K

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣3

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥5

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 5
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ K 10 8 5 3 2
 ♣ 9 2

♠ A Q 9 7 2

♥ 8 5

♦ A 9 6

♣ Q 10 4



♠ 8 3
 ♥ A 6 3 2
 ♦ Q J 7
 ♣ K 8 7 3

♠ K 6 4

♥ K Q 9 7 4

♦ 4

♣ A J 6 5

NORTH might well bid 3NT at his second turn, and this may turn out to be the final contract anyway.

But it doesn't hurt to bid 2♦ (Fourth Suit Forcing) just to see if SOUTH happens to have three ♠s. She does, so 4♠ becomes the better game.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♠3			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 7 6 3
♥ K 10 8 4
♦ K 4
♣ 5 2

♠ Q 9 4 2

♥ A 5

♦ J 6 5 3 2

♣ Q 9



♠ 8 5

♥ Q J 9 7

♦ A Q 9

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ J 10

♥ 6 3 2

♦ 10 8 7

♣ K J 10 7 6

EAST isn't strong enough to make a Reverse bid of 2♥ at his second turn.

WEST uses the 2♦ (NMF) bid to ask EAST for further description. EAST should first show a 4-card ♥ suit, and next show 3-card ♠ support.

Change EAST's ♥9 to the ♠9 and the contract would be 4♠.

West	North	East	South
		1♣	Pass
1♠	Pass	1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			
4♥ by East			
Lead: ♠J			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 3
 ♥ A J 10 3
 ♦ K Q J 6
 ♣ 10 6 3

♠ K 9 4 2

♥ 8

♦ 8 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 7



♠ 8 5
 ♥ K Q 9 4 2
 ♦ A 10 9
 ♣ J 5 2

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ 7 6 5

♦ 3

♣ A K 8 4

SOUTH's 3♥ bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

NORTH barely had enough strength to respond in the first place, but revaluing the hand, (and particularly the singleton ♥), makes it worth a raise to game.

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♦K			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ 8 7 4

♣ A J 10 3

♠ Q 9 8 6 3

♥ Q 10

♦ J 10 9 3

♣ K Q



♠ K 10

♥ A 9 7 5 4

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ 9 6

♠ 4 2

♥ J 8 3 2

♦ A 5

♣ 8 7 5 4 2

WEST has no reason to consider Fourth Suit Forcing with this hand.

EAST does not have four ♠s or he would have already supported.

So WEST should bid the Notrump game.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

3NT

2 ♦

Pass

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♣K

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 5 2

♥ K J

♦ J 9 3

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 7

♥ Q 10 9 7 6

♦ Q 7

♣ A 10 9 6

	N	
W		E
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♠ K 10 6 4

♥ 5 4

♦ A 10 5 2

♣ Q 8 3

♠ J 8 3

♥ A 8 3 2

♦ K 8 6 4

♣ 7 2

NORTH should pass 2♥. She is not strong enough to try for game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

Lead: ♣3

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 10 6 3

♥ K Q J 8

♦ 9 5

♣ Q 8

♠ J 7

♥ 9 6 4 2

♦ A 7 2

♣ 9 7 6 3



♠ 8 4

♥ A 10 7

♦ Q 10 6 4 3

♣ A K 2

♠ A 9 5 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K J 8

♣ J 10 5 4

WEST knows there should be game, but doesn't know whether it will be 4♠, 4♥ or 3NT. To find out which she uses NMF and bids 2♣ at her second turn.

EAST does not have a 4-card ♥ suit, nor does he have three ♠s, but he does have ♣s stopped so he bids 2NT, which West raises to 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		1♦	Pass
1♠	Pass	1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♥5			